

ute to saving our environment. Not to mention it'll make the roads a little safer and a happier place to be. —Lynn

Truong

10 Ways to Hold Off on Heating

Heating costs hit us every winter, but in my household we've implemented 10 strategies for keeping warm just a wee bit longer, sans heating unit.

1. Open the shades

Let the sun warm the house by opening the shades during the 10:00 AM–5:00 PM hours. Free heat feels so good.

2. Put an end to line drying

We enjoy hanging our clothes out on the line when it is warm. When the frost has fallen, we reverse our thinking to utilize the heat our dryer produces. Since our dryer wasn't vented outside our home, we use a lint receptacle to "catch" the lint. These kits are under \$15 at a hardware store, and in addition to the benefit of having the

dryer heat in our home, the added moisture is nice during the winter months. (Be sure to keep this system in check with weekly cleanings and adequate water to the trap. Families with allergies will need to be especially diligent.)

3. Dress in layers

I still see kids walking to school in shorts, despite the 35-degree mornings. This is ridiculous to me, as clothing is the cheapest way to stay warm in this season of transition. Once the first frost appears, I rid my kids' drawers of shorts and sleeveless tops, packing them up into plastic tubs for winter storage. They are free to choose from any of their winter clothing, and I encourage them to dress in a T-shirt under their warmer clothes for added warmth. They don't complain about the cold when they are properly dressed (including socks and indoor shoes).

